TRACKDECK

Product & Startup Roadmap

Every song. The right version.

Version 1.0 | November 2026 | Planning horizon: 9 months

Dates are targets for a small team, not promises. Revisit at every decision gate.

01 VISION

What TrackDeck is, and who it is for

TrackDeck moves a person's playlists between music services without making them search for every song again, and without silently replacing a track they love with a remix, a live cut or a karaoke copy. The promise is in the tagline: **every song, the right version.**

> **The one-sentence strategy**
> Win on **trust and accuracy** (transparent matching, nothing added until you approve it, no streaming-service login), not on supporting the most platforms. Competitors already have the breadth; they are weaker on showing their work.

Who it is for

- **Switchers:** people moving from one streaming service to another, who are the biggest and most urgent group.
- **Careful curators:** people with years of hand-built playlists, who care that the exact recording survives the move.
- **Backup-minded users:** people who want an exportable, service-independent copy of their library.
- **Later:** DJs, playlist creators and artists who need playlists to work across services.

Why people would choose it

Promise	How the product delivers it	Status
Right version, always	Scores title, artist, album and length; penalizes remix, live, karaoke, sped-up and cover mismatches; exact ISRC match wins.	Built
You stay in control	Uncertain matches are held for review with alternatives and scores; skipping is always safe.	Built
No login required	Upload a file you exported yourself. No streaming-service password or token is requested.	Built
Your data is yours	Original-playlist backup export; automatic 24-hour deletion; one-click delete.	Built
Lands on your service	Write the playlist directly to the destination account.	Planned (Phase 2)

02 WHERE WE ARE TODAY

An honest inventory

TrackDeck today is a complete, tested **file-in, file-out** product: users upload a playlist, review matches and download a clean file. It is not yet a one-click transfer to Spotify or YouTube Music, and that gap decides the roadmap.

Area	Built	Not built yet
Backend	FastAPI, SQLAlchemy async, SQLite and PostgreSQL; 11 endpoints; 64 automated tests passing (also run on PostgreSQL 16).	User accounts; Alembic migrations; durable job queue; metrics and error tracking.
Matching	Normalization, weighted scoring, ISRC fast path, version guard, ambiguity detection, optional LLM re-rank hook.	Accuracy measured on real playlists; tuned thresholds; evaluation harness.
Import / export	Spotify data export, CSV, TXT, JSON in; TXT, CSV, JSON out (source, matched, unmatched).	Direct library import via platform APIs; liked songs, albums, podcasts.
Catalog	MusicBrainz adapter with a shared 1 request/second throttle, cache and ISRC queries; mock catalog for demos.	Verified against the live service; a faster, commercial-grade catalog.
Reliability	Retry with backoff; resumable commits; atomic job claims; crash recovery; outage detection with Retry.	Idempotency keys for platform writes; multi-instance workers.
Safety	Upload size and track limits; per-IP upload limit; CORS allow-list; 24-hour data purge.	Auth and per-user ownership; abuse/captcha; formal privacy policy.
Frontend	Next.js app: WebGL trail-reveal hero with Sharingan awakening, upload flow, live progress, review screen, downloads, FAQ, pricing, features.	Account area, history, mobile polish pass, analytics, accessibility audit.
Deployment	Dockerfile, Render blueprint, DEPLOY.md for Vercel + Render + Neon free tiers.	Not yet deployed or smoke-tested on the live MusicBrainz API.

The strategic gap

Competitors typically log into both services and move the playlist in one step. TrackDeck's file-export flow proves the matching idea and costs nothing to run, but on its own it is **a smaller promise than the incumbents make**. The roadmap therefore uses file-export to *validate demand and matching quality*, then adds a real destination.

A crowded category, with a specific opening

Playlist transfer is an established category. The figures below come from third-party reviews and app listings gathered during research. They are directional, not audited; verify them before using them in marketing.

Tool	Known for	Paid features (per reviews)	What we can learn
Soundiiz	40+ services; sync, smart links, batch tools, transfer history.	Auto-sync, batch editing, history, unlimited transfers.	Advanced features sit behind Premium. One review timed a 200-track transfer at about 4m42s.
TuneMyMusic	Simple, web-only, 20+ services.	Premium tier removes limits.	Speed and simplicity win. The same review timed 200 tracks at about 15 seconds.
FreeYourMusic	Free tier up to about 600 songs per its app listing; backups and mobile apps.	Unlimited transfers, extras.	Generous free limit is the benchmark we are measured against.
STAMP / SongShift	One-time purchase (STAMP); iOS-native (SongShift).	Varies.	Proof that one-time payment and platform-native apps both have buyers.

Where TrackDeck can be different

- **Transparent matching:** show the score, the reason and the alternatives. Reviews describe incumbents as a black box that sometimes picks wrong versions.
- **Review-before-write:** nothing is added until the user approves the doubtful tracks.
- **Privacy-first:** no login for the file flow, automatic deletion, and a backup the user keeps.
- **A distinct identity:** the Uchiha-themed experience is memorable in a category of identical-looking tools.

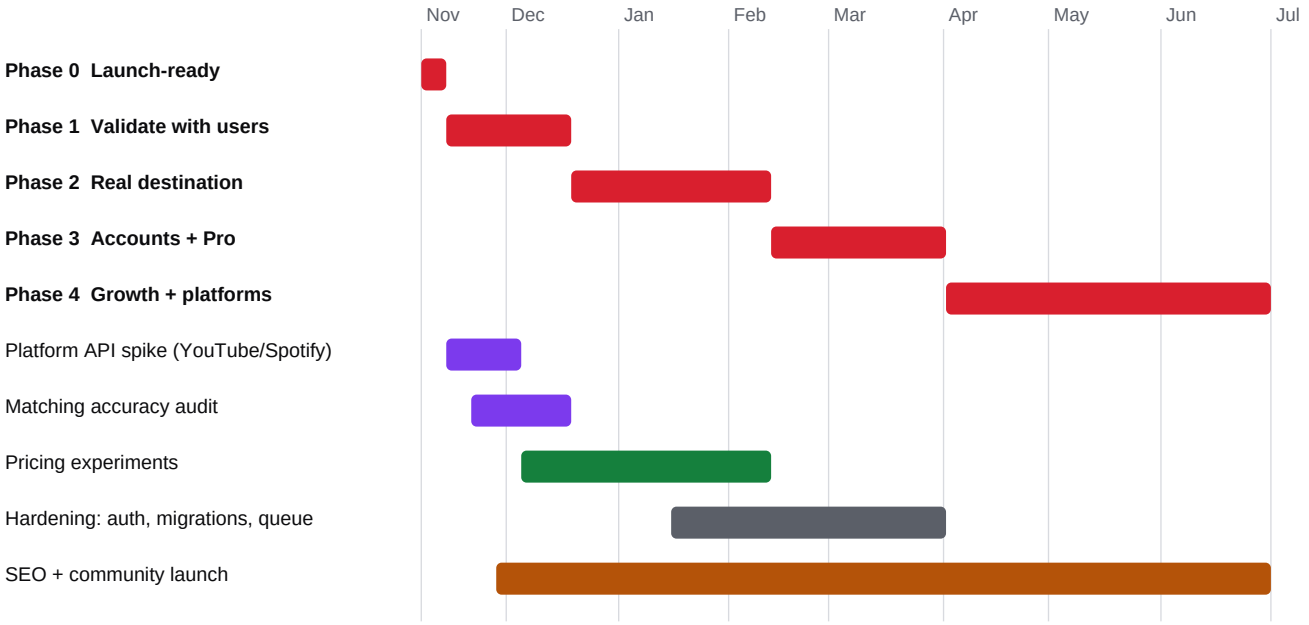
Where we are currently weaker

- **Breadth:** one catalog and no direct destinations today, against 20 to 45 services for incumbents.
- **Speed:** MusicBrainz is limited to about one request per second shared across all users, so a 500-song playlist takes minutes.
- **Brand and trust:** incumbents have years of reviews and search ranking.

04 ROADMAP AT A GLANCE

Five phases, each ending at a decision gate

Start date assumed: Monday 9 November 2026. Parallel tracks (violet, green, grey, amber) run alongside the main phases.



Phase	Target window	Goal	Gate to proceed
0 Launch-ready	Week 0 to 1 (9 to 15 Nov)	Deploy and smoke-test the product on real playlists.	Live URL works end to end on the real catalog.
1 Validate	Weeks 1 to 6 (to ~20 Dec)	20 to 50 real users transfer real playlists; measure quality and demand.	Evidence people want it and matches are trustworthy.
2 Real destination	Weeks 6 to 14 (to ~15 Feb)	Create playlists directly on YouTube (and Spotify if permitted).	Direct transfers work for beta users.
3 Accounts + Pro	Weeks 14 to 21 (to ~5 Apr)	Accounts, history, payments, hardened infrastructure.	First paying customers.
4 Growth	Weeks 21 to 34 (to ~5 Jul)	More platforms, sync, sharing, SEO and partnerships.	Repeatable acquisition and retention.

Timing assumes roughly one focused builder plus part-time design and marketing effort. Windows slide if platform approval takes longer than expected; the gates matter more than the dates.

05 PHASE 0 | WEEK 0 TO 1

Launch-ready: ship what exists

Goal
Get the current product live, prove it works against the real MusicBrainz service, and remove anything that could embarrass or endanger the launch.

Deliverables

- Deploy using DEPLOY.md: Neon (database), Render (API), Vercel (web). Set the real MusicBrainz contact email and CORS origin.
- **Smoke test with real playlists:** a 20-song CSV, then a real Spotify export. The MusicBrainz adapter has only been tested with faked responses so far.
- Replace the placeholder *hello@trackdeck.app* with a working contact address; buy a domain.
- Write a short privacy policy: what is stored, 24-hour deletion, no accounts, no streaming credentials.
- **Resolve the artwork question.** The Sasuke imagery is third-party copyrighted character art. Decide: license it, commission original art in the same spirit, or accept the takedown risk before charging money.
- Add privacy-respecting analytics (page view, upload, matching complete, review resolved, download) so Phase 1 can measure the funnel.
- Set up error tracking and an uptime monitor.

Exit criteria (the gate)

- The live site completes upload, match, review and download for two different real playlists.
- Obscure songs land in review, not silently wrong.
- Analytics events fire and a funnel is visible.

Risks to watch

- Render's free server sleeps when idle, so first visits take up to a minute (the UI says so, but watch bounce rate).
- MusicBrainz field names or ISRC coverage differ from the test fixtures; fix the adapter quickly if so.

06 PHASE 1 | WEEKS 1 TO 6

Validate: do real people want this?

Goal
Learn whether the problem is real and whether TrackDeck's accuracy is good enough to trust. Do not add platforms until this is answered.

Deliverables

- **Recruit 20 to 50 testers** from music and streaming communities, friends of friends, and anyone who has recently switched services.
- Ask each tester to transfer a real playlist and watch or record at least ten sessions (with consent).
- **Accuracy audit:** hand-label 200 or more auto-matched tracks across genres and languages; compute how many were wrong. Tune thresholds from this.
- Build a small evaluation harness from the labeled set so every matching change is measured, not guessed.
- Interview 10 users: what almost stopped them? would they pay, and for what? what did they expect that it did not do?
- Fix the top three problems the data reveals; resist feature requests that serve one person.
- Run the platform API spike (see Phase 2) in parallel so the next phase starts with facts.

Exit criteria (the gate)

- Targets (assumptions to adjust, not facts): at least 10 users finish a transfer on their own; at least half of uploads reach a download; wrong auto-matches below about 2%; at least 5 users say they would use it again or recommend it.
- A clear answer to: is the file-export version valuable on its own, or only as a stepping stone to direct transfer?

Risks to watch

- Testers are friends and will be polite. Weight what people do over what they say.
- If most users abandon at 'download a file, then what?', the file-only product is not enough, and Phase 2 becomes urgent.
- MusicBrainz slowness may itself cause drop-off; log time-to-first-result.

07 PHASE 2 | WEEKS 6 TO 14

A real destination: write the playlist for the user

Goal
Close the biggest gap with incumbents by creating the playlist directly in the user's streaming account, using official, permitted APIs only.

Deliverables

- **Week 1 of the phase is research, not code:** read the current API terms, quotas, OAuth scopes and any app-review or verification requirements for YouTube and Spotify. Verify before promising anything; policies change.
- Build the **YouTube playlist adapter** first (official API, playlist creation supported) on the existing adapter interface: OAuth flow, token refresh, quota handling, batch writes, per-track failure reporting.
- If Spotify permits it for a new app, add a Spotify adapter; if access is restricted, document the limitation and keep file-export as the Spotify route.
- Use the destination's own search for matching. It is typically faster than MusicBrainz and returns playable IDs, which removes the throughput limit and improves accuracy.
- Keep the review step: the user approves before anything is written. Show a post-transfer report with the destination playlist link.
- Add idempotency and recorded-fixture tests per adapter, so retries never duplicate tracks and API changes are caught early.

Exit criteria (the gate)

- A beta user can go from upload to a finished playlist in their own account without touching a file.
- Success rate and wrong-match rate on direct transfers meet or beat the Phase 1 file results.

Risks to watch

- **Platform risk is the largest in the business.** Approval can be slow, quotas small, or terms restrictive. Have a fallback: lead with the platforms that allow it and keep file-export as the universal route.
- OAuth means holding tokens: encrypt at rest, keep scopes minimal, delete on completion, and update the privacy policy.

08 PHASE 3 | WEEKS 14 TO 21

Accounts, payments and hardening

Goal
Turn a free tool into a business: identify users, let them return, charge for what is worth paying for, and make the system dependable.

Deliverables

- **Authentication** (email or social login) and per-user ownership of transfers; stop relying on unguessable IDs alone.
- **Transfer history** and saved playlists, which are also the foundation for Pro features.
- **Payments:** choose a provider that supports the business's country of registration (for example Stripe or Razorpay); handle taxes and invoices correctly.
- **Pro tier** based on what Phase 1 interviews showed people would pay for (see section 10). No price is set until the evidence supports one.
- **Infrastructure:** Alembic migrations; durable job queue and worker (for example ARQ with Redis) replacing in-process jobs; Redis-backed rate limiting; paid always-on hosting so there is no cold start; automated database backups; CI that runs the test suite on every change.
- Observability: structured logs, error tracking, dashboards for match rate, queue depth, API error rates and cost per transfer.

Exit criteria (the gate)

- First paying customers, even a handful, with a working checkout and refund process.
- No known data-ownership or duplicate-write bugs; the system recovers from a restart with no manual work.

Risks to watch

- Charging raises legal duties (terms of service, tax, refunds, data protection). Budget time for them.
- Do not charge before resolving the MusicBrainz commercial-use question and the artwork rights (see risk register).

09 PHASE 4 | WEEKS 21 TO 34

Growth: breadth, retention and acquisition

Goal
Make TrackDeck the default recommendation for careful music movers, and give existing users reasons to come back.

Deliverables

- **More destinations** in order of demand and API openness (for example Apple Music, Deezer, Tidal, Amazon Music); each is one adapter on the existing interface.
- **More content types:** liked songs, saved albums and artists, then podcasts if demanded.
- **Retention features:** scheduled sync between two services, playlist backup snapshots, change history.
- **Shareable smart links** for a playlist that opens on whichever service a viewer uses.
- **SEO landing pages** for each route (for example 'Spotify to YouTube Music'); incumbents win much of their traffic this way.
- **Partnerships:** explore referral arrangements with streaming services or creator communities, where terms permit.
- **Data quality:** evaluate a commercial catalog or paid MusicBrainz data feed for speed, coverage and clear licensing.
- A mobile-friendly progressive web app before any native app.

Exit criteria (the gate)

- Acquisition that does not depend on the founder posting personally.
- Returning-user rate and Pro conversion are measured and trending up, with cost per transfer known.

Risks to watch

- Chasing every platform dilutes accuracy; add one at a time and measure each.
- Sync features multiply support load. Launch them only after single transfers are rock solid.

10 BUSINESS MODEL

How TrackDeck could earn money, to be validated

Start free, learn what people value, then charge for it. These are hypotheses to test, not commitments. **No price is proposed here** because none is supported by evidence yet.

Model	How it would work	Best when	How to test
Free tier	Capped tracks per transfer; file export; review tools.	Always. It is the acquisition engine.	Track free-to-paid conversion.
Pro subscription	Larger playlists, direct transfer, history, sync, priority matching.	Users return regularly or manage many playlists.	Waitlist and pre-sell before building.
One-time migration pass	Pay once to move a whole library.	Most users switch services once; this matches that behavior.	Offer both and compare take-up.
Referrals / partnerships	Referral fees or co-marketing where platform terms allow.	After scale; terms vary by platform.	Explore only after Phase 3.
Creator / B2B	Bulk tools or an API for DJs, labels and curators.	Demand appears from creators.	Interview five creators first.

What to measure before setting prices

- **Cost per transfer:** API calls, compute and support time. It is near zero on free tiers today and will rise with paid hosting and catalog fees.
- **Willingness to pay:** ask directly in interviews, then confirm with a real pre-order or waitlist-to-checkout test.
- **Conversion funnel:** visit, upload, match complete, review, download, return, upgrade.
- Competitors' free limits are the reference point; a free tier far below them will feel stingy.

> **A caution on the free catalog**
> MusicBrainz's free web service is intended for light, non-commercial use. If TrackDeck earns money, read the current MetaBrainz commercial-use policy and budget for a paid data feed or a destination-API catalog. This is a gating item for Phase 3.

Finding the first 50, then the first 500

Who and where

- **People mid-switch** are the best audience because their need is urgent. Reach them where they ask for help: music and streaming communities, forums and answer sites.
- **Launch moments:** a Product Hunt or Hacker News style launch after Phase 1, with real user stories and an honest accuracy number.
- **Search:** route pages ('Spotify to YouTube Music', 'export Spotify playlist to CSV'), guides on getting a Spotify data export, and 'why did my transfer pick the wrong version?' content.
- **Short videos:** a clean demo of the Sharingan-awakening hero and the 'it caught the karaoke version' review moment are naturally shareable.

Messaging

Message	Proof it must carry
Every song. The right version.	Show a before-and-after where an incumbent-style match would have picked a remix.
Nothing is added until you say so.	The review screen with scores and alternatives.
No login. Your file, your data.	24-hour deletion and the backup download.

Funnel metrics to instrument from day one

- Visit to upload start; upload to matching complete; matching complete to review resolved; review to download; download to return within 30 days.
- Quality: share of auto-matches later changed by users (a proxy for wrong auto-matches), and share of tracks unresolved.
- Operational: time to first result, queue wait, retry rate, catalog error rate.

The engineering backlog, in priority order

#	Item	Why it matters	Phase
1	Live smoke test of the MusicBrainz adapter	Only fixture-tested so far; real field names may differ.	0
2	Analytics, error tracking, uptime monitor	You cannot improve what you cannot see.	0
3	Matching evaluation harness from labeled data	Makes every matching change measurable.	1
4	Platform API research spike	De-risks the biggest unknown before building.	1
5	YouTube (and Spotify if permitted) adapters with OAuth	Delivers the real destination promise.	2
6	Idempotent writes + recorded-fixture adapter tests	Prevents duplicate tracks and silent API drift.	2
7	Authentication and per-user ownership	Replaces ID-only privacy; required for history and billing.	3
8	Alembic migrations	Safe schema changes in production.	3
9	Durable queue and worker (ARQ/Redis), Redis rate limiting	Survives restarts and scales beyond one process.	3
10	Payments, subscriptions, invoices	Revenue.	3
11	CI pipeline, automated DB backups, staging environment	Safe, repeatable releases.	3
12	Token encryption, secrets management, security review	Required once OAuth tokens are held.	2 to 3
13	Sync engine, smart links, library-wide transfer	Retention and differentiation.	4
14	Accessibility audit and mobile polish of the WebGL hero	Reach and quality; fallback already exists for reduced motion.	1 to 4

Architecture principle to keep: **adapters are the only code that knows about a music service.** The pipeline, matching engine and API stay platform-neutral, so adding a service is one new adapter plus tests.

13 RISK REGISTER

What could go wrong, and what we do about it

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Platform API access is denied, restricted or changes	Medium to high	High	Research first; lead with permissive platforms; keep file-export as the universal route; never build on scraping or credential collection.
MusicBrainz commercial terms and 1 request/second limit	High once monetized	High	Read terms before charging; move to destination-API search or a paid feed; cache aggressively.
Incumbents are good enough and free	High	High	Compete on transparency, accuracy and privacy; measure the wrong-version rate honestly and publish it.
Copyright claim over the character artwork	Medium	Medium to high	License it, commission original art, or switch before monetizing; keep the effect and layout, which are independent of the character.
Matching quality disappoints on non-English or niche music	Medium	High	Labeled audit across languages; review-first design; improve normalization per language.
User distrust of uploading listening data	Medium	Medium	Plain-language privacy policy, 24-hour deletion, no login, open about the catalog used.
Free-tier limits (sleep, quotas, storage) hurt experience	High	Low to medium	Warm-up messaging now; paid always-on hosting in Phase 3.
Duplicate or lost tracks on write failures	Low to medium	High	Resumable checkpoints exist; add idempotency keys and per-adapter fixture tests.
Legal and tax duties once payments start	Certain	Medium	Terms, refunds, tax setup and a data-protection review before the first charge.
Founder bandwidth	High	High	Ruthless scope control; gates decide what to build; automate support answers in the FAQ.

When to double down, pivot or stop

Decision gates

After	If the evidence says...	Then
Phase 1	Users finish transfers, trust the matches and ask 'can it just add it to my account?'	Proceed to Phase 2 with confidence.
Phase 1	Users are happy with the file output and would pay for it.	Strengthen file export (more formats, backups) and delay platform work.
Phase 1	Users drop off at the download step or find matching too slow or wrong.	Fix catalog speed and quality first; do not add features.
Phase 2	No permitted route to write to major platforms.	Pivot toward a backup-and-portability product (own your library), or niche (creators, DJs).
Phase 3	Nobody pays at any tested price after honest attempts.	Reconsider the model (one-time pass, B2B, sponsorship) before more engineering.

Your next 14 days

- **Day 1 to 2:** deploy via DEPLOY.md; set the contact email and CORS; run the smoke test on two real playlists.
- **Day 2 to 4:** decide the artwork path; write the privacy policy; set up analytics, error tracking and an uptime monitor.
- **Day 4 to 7:** fix whatever the smoke test breaks, then invite the first five testers and watch them use it.
- **Day 7 to 14:** grow to 20 testers; start the accuracy audit; read the YouTube and Spotify API terms and write down exactly what each allows.
- **Day 14:** review the first funnel numbers and decide what Phase 1's remaining weeks should focus on.

> **Assumptions behind this plan**
> One primary builder; the free-tier stack in DEPLOY.md; no external funding; platform policies and competitor details as researched in November 2026 and subject to change. Numeric targets are starting hypotheses to be revised with real data. Verify third-party facts before public use.